

trimmed down as Motorola's Hello UI, NothingOS, or stock Android.

AI FEATURES AND DIGIT AI-Q SCORE

The 2024 Samsung Unpacked Event not only unveiled new foldables and smart-watches but also expanded its Galaxy AI portfolio with a suite of new AI features. The new features consist of automatic transcription, translation, and summarisation for voice recordings, as well as PDF overlay translation. There's a Sketch to Image feature that lets you draw objects on images within the Gallery or in the Notes app, which AI can then replace with actual objects.

Portrait Studio is a fun one that creates various portrait styles like 3D cartoon or watercolour, adding a creative touch to your photos. Samsung has also improved the Interpreter feature for live translation. This feature now includes a special conversation mode tailored for the foldable form factor. In this mode, each party in the conversation can see the translation on different screens – one on the main screen and the other on the cover screen.

Composer, integrated into the Samsung Keyboard, can now generate text based on simple keywords. Circle to Search is a system-wide feature that allows you to highlight any part of the screen to search for an object online. And, the Google Gemini app is now fully integrated into the new Galaxy Z series as well.

Samsung's Galaxy Z Flip6 is packed with AI features aimed at enhancing user experience and productivity; it is one of the most feature-packed AI phones you can get in the foldable smartphone market.

Aside from testing out the new AI features, we also ran our usual slew of AI benchmarks to gauge the device's NPU capabilities. The phone's AI benchmark scores were much higher than its biggest competitor, the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra. In fact, the Z Flip6 got an overall Digit AI-Q score of 85 while the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra only got a score of 32, which highlights the disparity between the two phones and the Z Flip6's on-device AI processing chops.

CAMERAS

The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 sees a substantial upgrade in the camera department. A new 50 MP f/1.8 primary camera replaces the old 12 MP unit that was present on its predecessor. The 12 MP ultrawide camera and the 10 MP selfie camera are carried over from the Z Flip5 though, so no changes there.

The upgraded 50 MP camera clicks binned 12 MP images by default which produces realistic colours, excellent detail, and good contrast. The oversharpening issue that was present on the Z Flip5 has been resolved here. The dynamic range is very impressive, and the Z Flip6 manages to control highlights and shadows particularly well even in tricky lighting situations.

Portrait photography has improved too, with lesser smoothening of facial textures, more accurate skin tones, and good edge detection. The 12 MP ultrawide camera is decent, there are still some remnants of the oversharpening issue from last year, but this mostly happens in low light.

As for low-light photography from the main camera, it is quite good. There is some noise in darker areas, but the detail, dynamic range, and colours are on point. Additionally, lens flare is also largely under control. The 10 MP selfie camera does a decent job in daylight but outputs soft photos in low light; you would be better off using the 50 MP shooter as a selfie camera on the cover screen since it is capable of clicking much more detailed selfies. You can also switch to the ultrawide camera to click groupies!

BATTERY LIFE

The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 houses a larger 4,000 mAh and, the battery endurance is quite good, I got a screen-on time of 7-8 hours on most days, which is pretty decent for a flip-style foldable given the lack of space for a larger battery.

In our 4K video loop test, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 lasted a respectable 14.5 hours which is a decent jump compared to the Galaxy Z Flip5 which lasted only 12 hours and 38 minutes in the same test.

The charging speeds remain as laboriously slow as ever though. The phone supports 25 W wired charging, 15 W wire-

less charging, and 4.5 W reverse wireless charging. The Z Flip6 tops up from 0-100 per cent in 1 hour and 41 minutes, which is sluggish in comparison to the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra which does the same in just 48 minutes.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6, while an incremental upgrade rather than a groundbreaking one, brings significant refinements over its predecessor that enhance the overall user experience. Key improvements include a larger battery, an enhanced IP rating with dust protection, an upgraded 50 MP primary camera, and the latest Snapdragon SoC. These enhancements, combined with its class-leading performance, make the Z Flip6 a compelling choice. Priced ₹10,000 higher than the Z Flip5, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip6 is ideal for those seeking a flagship experience with top-tier performance, extended software support, and advanced AI features. It excels in these areas, maintaining a significant lead over competitors. However, the Motorola Razr 50 Ultra and OPPO Find N3 Flip surpass it in cover screen functionality and camera versatility. Samsung needs to address the cover screen in future iterations to maintain its competitive edge. Despite this, the Galaxy Z Flip6 remains one of the best foldable smartphones available in the Indian market today, offering a premium experience that justifies the price hike for many users.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 750 | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage: 256/512 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: Android 14, One UI 6.1.1 | Inner display: 6.7" Foldable Dynamic LTPO AMOLED 2X, 120 Hz, HDR10+, 1080 x 2640 pixels | Cover display: 3.4" Super AMOLED, 720 x 748 pixels | Cover display protection: Gorilla Glass Victus 2 | Cameras (rear) + 50 MP + 12 MP | Selfie camera: 10 MP | Video (front and rear): Up to 4K at 60 fps | Battery capacity: 4,000 mAh | Charging: 25 W (wired), 15 W (wireless), 4.5 W (reverse wireless) | IP rating: IP48 | Weight: 187 g

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